VENUE TECH

ILLINOIS × DAKTRONICS

INSIDE THE LARGEST VIDEO BOARD IN COLLEGE FOOTBALL

What it took to build and run the new board at Gies Memorial Stadium

SWIPE →

THE BUILD

HOW DAKTRONICS PUT THE BOARD UP

1 PLAN THE FIT

Daktronics took stock of the site. Little space behind the south side of the stadium meant careful planning of footings and structure.

2 STRENGTHEN THE STADIUM

The engineering included strengthening some of the preexisting concrete, per Jeremy Lomax.

3 HANG THE SCREEN

315 panels, each roughly 8 feet by 8 feet, are made up of smaller LED modules: 10,070 in total.

4 CONTROL ROOMS

One team works from a control room on the stadium's eighth floor. A second control room sits in the Bielfeldt Athletics Administration Building.

THE PEOPLE

WHO BUILT IT AND WHO RUNS IT

BW

BROCK WALLEN @
Senior project manager
Daktronics

RK

RYAN KUZMAN
Regional salesperson
Daktronics

JL

JEREMY LOMAX @
Senior project manager
Anthony James Partners

DM

DERRYL MYLES @
Senior Associate Director of Athletics, Fighting Illini Productions & Technology
Illinois

JW

JOSH WHITMAN
Director of Athletics
Illinois

THE SIZE

THE MAIN DISPLAY AT GIES MEMORIAL STADIUM

17,315

square feet

16M

pixels

10,070

LED modules

1,621

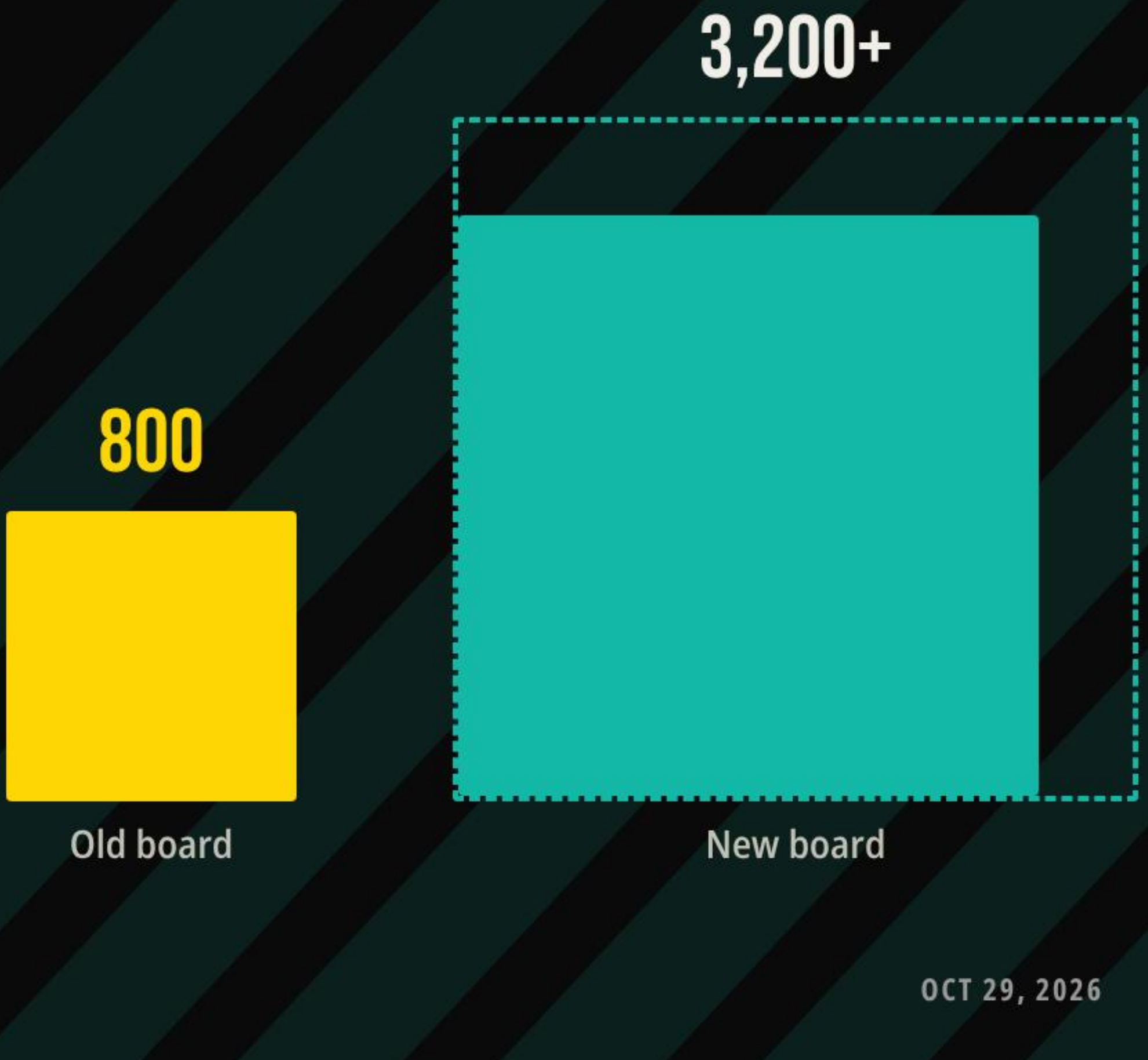
60-inch TVs to cover it

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THE POWER

POWER DRAW: THE OLD BOARD AGAINST THE NEW ONE

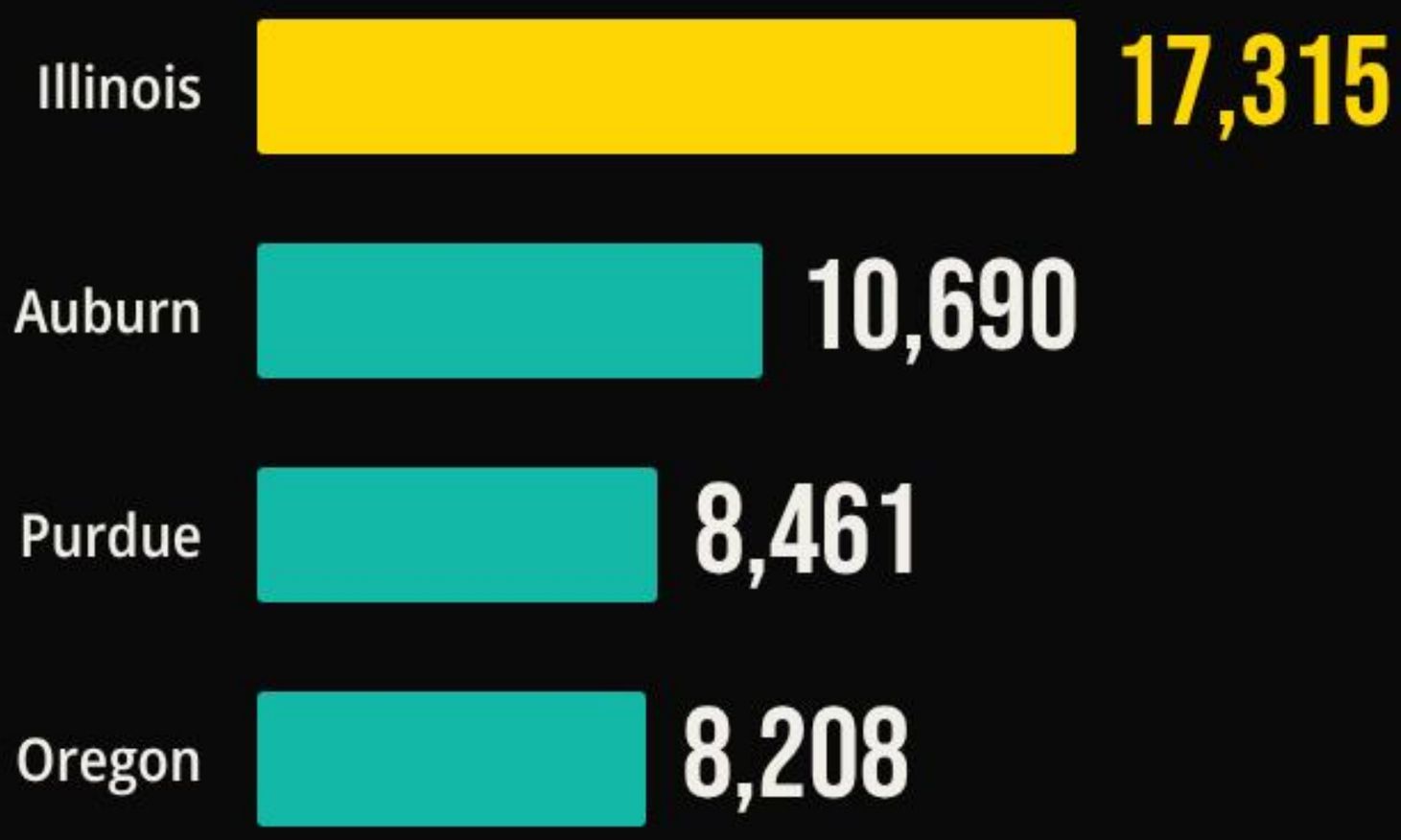
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COLLEGE FOOTBALL

LARGEST MAIN VIDEO DISPLAYS IN COLLEGE FOOTBALL, PER DAKTRONICS (JAN. 2026)

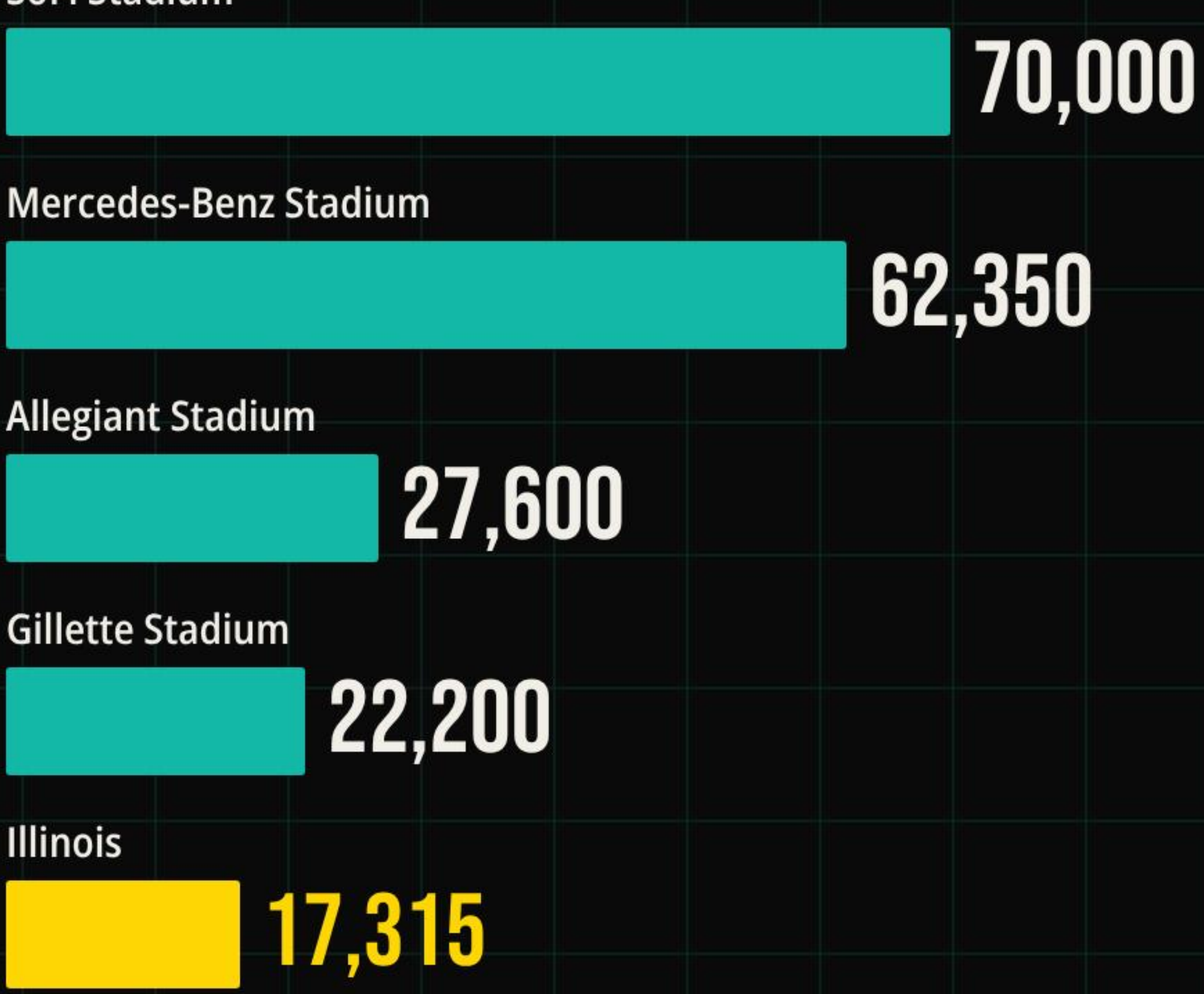
sq. ft.



AGAINST THE NFL

THE BIGGEST U.S. STADIUM BOARDS STILL DWARF IT, PER SPORTING NEWS

sq. ft.



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TIMELINE

FROM ANNOUNCEMENT TO GAME DAY

JAN 14, 2026

SBJ reports Illinois is installing the board as part of a $29M offseason renovation

SEP 2, 2026

Sports Video Group reports the board will debut Thursday night against UAB

OCT 29, 2026

The Daily Illini details the technology behind the board

GAME DAY

WHAT THE SIZE CHANGED FOR THE PRODUCTION TEAM

1 WIDE CANVAS

Conventional 16:9 video does not naturally fit the board. Full board, Myles said, loses 50% of the image once scaled.

2 A WINDOW FOR LIVE VIDEO

For much of the game, live video will reside in a dedicated window, with room for statistics, graphics and sponsorship.

3 LONGER RUNWAY

Rendering videos and animations takes a little longer, so preparation starts earlier.

4 THREE SECTIONS

During the game, the production team splits the screen into three sections, per Wallen and Kuzman.

“

There was a lot of work that was done ahead of time to make sure that everything would work out in the end.

BROCK WALLEN

Senior project manager, Daktronics

OCT 29, 2026

SOURCES

SOURCES

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sportsvideo.org

Daktronics: Illinois, Daktronics Install Largest Video Display in College Football
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Sports Business Journal: Illinois installing college football's largest videoboard ahead of 2026 season
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Sporting News: Inside Illinois' new $20.9M jumbotron, the biggest in college football history
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